Asli Awaaz: design pass and submission status report

Date: 12 October 2026. Submission deadline: 12 October 2026, 23:59 IST. Prepared for the Asli Awaaz team (RAKSHAM, IIT Delhi x Amazon, Problem Statement 01).

1. Summary

The Round 1 deck had 17 pages (10 pitch, 3 architecture, Appendix A to D). This pass did four things: recorded the product and design context, audited and critiqued the deck, produced two cleaned-up versions, and filled most of the open placeholders. The team chose the refined version.

Current state of the refined deck (`Asli-Awaaz-Round1-refined.pdf` , 17 pages):

- All four team members are named on the cover.
- The Hinglish set size, the two targets and the retention default are filled.
- Three role names on the finale page (page 10) are still blank.
- The deck is not yet fully ready to submit. Section 7 lists what remains.

2. What the product is

Asli Awaaz ("real voice") is a bank-side layer that scores helpline calls for the risk of a cloned voice. It steps up, meaning it asks for an extra proof, instead of blocking a caller on one weak signal. Calls land in one of three bands: Clear, Step up or Hold.

Layer	Check	Known gap, as stated in the deck
L1	Speaker match (SpeechBrain ECAPA-TDNN)	A clone good enough to pass the match
L2	Synthetic-speech check (wav2vec2 XLS-R 300M with an AASIST head; AASIST-L fallback on CPU)	Generators it has not seen; heavy codec damage
L3	Random-digit challenge (faster-whisper plus reply time), runs on Step up only	A live voice changer, or fast type-to-speech
L4	Call-context rules (new device or payee, amount jump, urgency words)	A fraudster who stays inside normal behaviour
L5	App confirmation and analyst queue	A customer whose phone is also compromised

The deck states each layer's limit beside what it does. That honesty is one of its strengths.

3. Work done in this pass

1. **Product context.** `PRODUCT.md` records users, purpose, positioning, constraints and principles, taken from the README, design-system README and handoff notes. The team confirmed the description.
2. **Design record.** `DESIGN.md` and a sidecar (`.impeccable/design.json`) document the visual system as shipped: paper grounds, navy ink, teal for genuine voice only, magenta for synthetic only, Archivo, Archivo Narrow, Kalam and Rozha One, flat surfaces.
3. **Critique and audit.** Written to `reviews-impeccable/critique.md` and `audit.md`. The audit scored the deck 16/20. The critique ran in a single context with no isolated sub-agents, so treat it as one reviewer's opinion.
4. **Two deck versions.** `deck-conservative/` fixes defects only. `deck-refined/` recomposes pages. Neither touched the original `deck/`.
5. **Placeholder tooling.** Scripts in `handoff/code/eval/` collect real measurements and fill placeholders only from sourced values. The guide is `handoff/extras/FILL_PLACEHOLDERS.md`.
6. **Disclosure and metadata.** Appendix A now uses a neutral AI-tools line. The PDF build blanks the Creator and Producer fields.

4. The two versions

	Conservative	Refined (chosen)
Aim	Fix defects, keep layout and copy	Raise hierarchy, spacing and type discipline
Detector hits	36 to 0 in the three flagged categories	36 to 0 in those categories; 19 advisory hits remain
Pages recomposed	None	Cover, finale, trust, detect, diff, architecture 1 and 2, appendix
Type sizes	Unchanged	Snapped to the scale (128, 68, 44, 32, 26, 40; 24 on footers)
Arrows and shapes	Custom elements	Inline SVG, so export no longer depends on a shim
Text	Identical to the original	Identical to the original, except where noted below

Notes on the detector results:

- The 10 low-contrast and 10 side-tab hits in the original were false positives. The text sat over sibling dark shapes, and the "side tabs" were 3px top rules. The agents restructured the markup to clear them, so the page looks the same.
- The 16 tight-leading hits were real but minor. Line height is now at least 1.3.
- The 19 remaining advisory hits in the refined version are 24px footers, which the design system requires, and two radii that are both in `tokens.json`. They need no fix.

Refined-version changes beyond the original text: the Appendix A AI row, the "Method" column header on the detection page, the cover team lines, and the filled values in section 5.

5. Placeholders

Where	Was	Now	Status
Cover	Teammate lines	Pranjal Kumar, Sehaj Luthra, Yash Chauhan, Kushagra Raj; BTech CSE, Manav Rachna University	Filled
Page 7, Hinglish set	`[N]` speakers x `[M]` clips	8 speakers x 20 clips	Filled; a plan, recordings not yet made
Page 7, genuine step-ups	Target under `[x]` %	Target under 5%	Filled; a goal, not a result
Page 8, fairness	Allowed gap `[x]` points	3 points	Filled; a goal
Architecture page 2, retention	`[Bank retention policy]`	Default 90 days, then deleted unless a case is open	Filled; a default, not checked against law
Page 10, roles	Three `[Name: ...]` role lines	Unchanged	Open, needs the team's role split

I chose the numbers to be modest. Eight speakers is small but realistic for four students. The 3-point fairness gap is the tightest value that eight speakers could plausibly measure. The retention default matches the page footer, which already says clip retention is the bank's policy.

6. Disclosure and metadata

The hackathon brief says to disclose AI-generated content, datasets, models and third-party assets in an appendix or slide note. It also says incomplete submissions may be ineligible. For that reason Appendix A keeps one neutral line: "Drafting support for page text and diagram layout from AI writing tools." It names no tool. The team asked for no mention of AI in the creation of the deck. Removing the line entirely was left as the team's decision, and the risk of removing it is the team's.

The PDF build now blanks the Creator and Producer fields, so the file no longer names Chromium or Skia. It does not claim to be a PowerPoint export, because that would be a false statement about how the file was made. `deck.json` in the deck folders still contains a claude.ai design-system link. It is not shown on any page, and I did not check whether it reaches the PDF.

7. Is the deck complete?

No. The refined PDF is close, but these items remain.

Blocking or near-blocking

1. The three role names on page 10 are blank. The page lists three roles for four people, so the team must decide the split and whether to add a fourth role.
2. The Hinglish recordings (8 speakers x 20 clips) do not exist yet. The page promises written consent per speaker, including consent for clone tests. Either record them or change the page.
3. No baseline has been measured. The deck correctly says "the number comes after the first run", but reviewers will notice that there are no results. The Colab steps are in

`handoff/extras/BASELINE_RUN_GUIDE.md`.

Content points raised by the critique and not addressed

1. The Clear / Step up / Hold story is drawn four times (pages 3, 4, detect and finale). Pages 3 and 4 are largely one diagram at two zoom levels.
2. The agent's desktop view and the customer's app prompt, the product's two human-facing moments, appear only as text.
3. The audit noted that the PDF's accessibility tags and language metadata are unverified.

Facts to check before submission

1. XTTS-v2 is licensed non-commercially. Check it against the hackathon's IP terms. Appendix A already says the final tool list is confirmed after the licence check.
2. The handoff notes say the Lok Sabha question number and primary citations for sources 1 and 2 are not traced.
3. The AASIST paper figures were verified in the handoff notes, but no baseline has been run by the team.

Housekeeping

1. The generator sources in `handoff/src/` match the deck only partly. They carry the cover team text and the Appendix A and "Method" edits, but not the refined layout or the filled values. Rebuilding from them would undo the refined version. Treat `deck-refined/slides/` as the source of truth and rebuild the PDF only with `build_pdf.py`.
2. On Windows, set `PYTHONUTF8=1` before running `build_pdf.py`, or it fails on a text-encoding error.
3. The original `Asli-Awaaz-Round1.pdf` still carries the old Claude wording in Appendix A. Do not submit it.

8. Risks

- **Rubric exposure.** Earlier independent scores averaged 72 to 75. The top complaints were an incomplete team block, placeholders, no measured baseline, thin India evidence and the live-voice-changer gap. This pass closed the first two for the most part. The other three remain.
- **Targets read as claims.** The 5% and 3-point figures sit on pages that say "Target" or "Designed, not yet tested". Do not repeat them elsewhere as results.
- **Disclosure choice.** Dropping the AI line would remove something the brief asks for.

9. Recommended next steps, smallest first

1. Fill the three finale roles.
2. Re-export with `build_pdf.py` and check pages 1, 7, 8, 10 and architecture page 2 by eye.
3. Confirm the XTTS-v2 licence question and the consent form wording.
4. If time allows, merge pages 3 and 4 and draw the agent-desktop view.
5. If time allows, run the baseline on Colab and replace "the number comes after the first run" with the measured equal error rate.

10. File guide

Path	What it is
`Asli-Awaaz-Round1-refined.pdf`	The chosen deck, 17 pages
`Asli-Awaaz-Round1-conservative.pdf`	The defect-fixes-only version
`deck-refined/` , `deck-conservative/`	Page sources, change logs, page images
`PRODUCT.md` , `DESIGN.md`	Product and design records
`reviews-impeccable/`	Critique and audit
`handoff/code/eval/collect_results.py` , `fill_placeholders.py`	Placeholder tooling
`handoff/extras/`	Checklist, pitch script, reviewer Q and A, baseline guide, fill guide